

OE-EC804C — Organizational Behavior

Module 2: Personality and Motivation

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1 Personality: Concept and Determinants

Personality represents the relatively stable set of psychological characteristics, behavioral patterns, and emotional tendencies that shape how an individual interacts with their environment.

Definition of Personality

Personality is the dynamic organization within the individual of those psychophysical systems that determine their unique adjustments to their environment (Gordon Allport).

1.1 Determinants of Personality

An individual's personality is shaped by four major determinants:

- 1. Heredity (Biological Factors):** Genetic traits inherited from parents (temperament, physical stature, reflexes, facial features). Twins studies show genetics accounts for nearly 50% of personality variation.
- 2. Environmental Factors:** Socialization, family background, upbringing, social status, and educational experiences during early childhood.
- 3. Cultural Factors:** Cultural norms, values, beliefs, and societal expectations that dictate acceptable behavior.
- 4. Situational Factors:** Specific events, crises, or work situations that constrain or draw out specific personality dimensions.

1.2 Personality Development: Theories and Stages

Personality development refers to the process by which an individual's unique behavioral patterns and psychological structures evolve over time:

- Freud's Psychoanalytic Theory:** Personality consists of three interacting structural systems:
 - Id*: Unconscious, primitive drive operating on the pleasure principle.
 - Ego*: Realistic, conscious executive operating on the reality principle.
 - Superego*: Moral conscience representing societal norms and ethical ideals.
- Erikson's 8 Psychosocial Stages:** Personality evolves through 8 life stages characterized by specific psychosocial crises (e.g., Trust vs. Mistrust, Identity vs. Role Confusion, Industry vs. Inferiority).
- Argyris' Immaturity-Maturity Continuum:** Chris Argyris proposed that individuals naturally progress along a continuum from infant **immaturity** (passive, dependent, short-term perspective) to adult **maturity** (active, independent, long-term perspective, self-awareness).

2 Personality Theories and Applications in OB

2.1 The Big Five Personality Traits Model (OCEAN)

The **Big Five Model** is the most widely validated framework for assessing personality traits in business settings:

Trait	High Score Characteristics	Organizational Impact
Openness to Experience	Creative, curious, imaginative, insightful, flexible.	Adapts quickly to organizational change & innovation.
Conscientiousness	Organized, dependable, thorough, disciplined, goal-driven.	Single strongest predictor of overall job performance.
Extraversion	Sociable, assertive, energetic, outgoing, talkative.	Performs exceptionally in sales, leadership, & networking.
Agreeableness	Cooperative, trusting, empathetic, warm, helpful.	Excels in teamwork, customer service, & conflict resolution.
Emotional Stability (vs. Neuroticism)	Calm, self-confident, secure, stress-resilient.	High job satisfaction; low occupational burnout.

2.2 Major Personality Attributes Influencing OB

- Locus of Control:** Belief about who controls destiny.
 - Internals*: Believe outcomes stem from their own effort. Higher job satisfaction & performance.
 - Externals*: Believe outcomes are driven by luck, fate, or external power. Higher stress.
- Machiavellianism (High-Mach):** Pragmatic, emotionally distant, and believes "the end justifies the means". Excels in high-stakes negotiations.
- Type A vs. Type B Personality:**
 - Type A*: Impatient, competitive, time-conscious, aggressive. Prone to work stress.
 - Type B*: Relaxed, patient, steady, non-competitive. Better long-term strategic thinkers.
- Self-Monitoring:** Ability to adjust behavior to external situational factors. High self-monitors are adept at political maneuvering.

3 Motivation: Concepts and Theories

Motivation is the psychological process that initiates, directs, and sustains goal-oriented human behavior.

Definition of Motivation

Motivation is the willingness to exert high levels of effort toward organizational goals, conditioned by the effort's ability to satisfy some individual need (Robbins).

3.1 The Motivation-Behavior Process

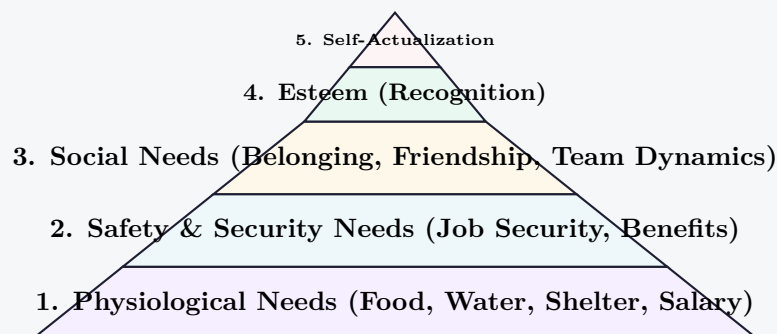
The 6-Stage Motivation-Behavior Process



3.2 Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs Theory

Abraham Maslow posited that human needs are arranged in a 5-level hierarchy. Individuals satisfy lower-order needs before progressing to higher-order needs:

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs Pyramid



3.3 Herzberg's Two-Factor (Hygiene-Motivator) Theory

Frederick Herzberg proposed that job satisfaction and job dissatisfaction are driven by two independent sets of factors:

Dimension	Hygiene Factors (Extrinsic)	Motivators (Intrinsic)
Primary Impact	Prevents job dissatisfaction (does NOT create motivation).	Generates high job satisfaction & intrinsic motivation.
Factors	Salary, company policies, working conditions, job security, supervision.	Achievement, recognition, responsibility, advancement, work itself.
Absence Result	Severe job dissatisfaction.	Neutral state (no satisfaction, but no dissatisfaction).

3.4 McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y

Douglas McGregor formulated two contrasting views of human workforce motivation:

Assumption Area	Theory X (Authoritarian View)	Theory Y (Participative View)
Attitude Toward Work	Inherently dislike work and avoid it whenever possible.	View work as natural as play or rest.
Ambition & Responsibility	Lack ambition, avoid responsibility, seek direction.	Exercise self-direction, seek responsibility.
Managerial Strategy	Strict control, coercion, punishment, close supervision.	Empowerment, delegation, participative decision-making.
Primary Motivator	Lower-order physiological & safety needs.	Higher-order esteem & self-actualization needs.

4 Elements of Sound Motivational System & Indian Context

4.1 Elements of a Sound Motivational System

A comprehensive managerial motivation strategy integrates financial and non-financial rewards:

- **Fair & Competitive Compensation:** Merit-based pay, profit sharing, and performance bonuses.
- **Job Enrichment:** Expanding job content vertically by giving greater autonomy, responsibility, and decision-making power.
- **Job Enlargement:** Expanding job content horizontally by adding a wider variety of similar tasks to eliminate monotony.
- **Employee Recognition Programs:** Awards, promotions, and public praise.

4.2 Motivation in Indian Organizations

Motivation strategies in Indian corporate environments account for cultural nuances (collectivism, respect for hierarchy, family orientation):

- High value placed on **job security** and institutional stability.
- Paternalistic leadership style offering personal care alongside professional direction.
- Growing shift toward performance-linked incentives (PLI) and stock options (ESOPs) in tech startups and IT sectors.

Quick Revision — Module 2

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Key Concepts and Metrics at a Glance

Big Five OCEAN	Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, Neuroticism.
Locus of Control	Internal (effort controls outcomes) vs. External (luck/fate controls outcomes).
Maslow's Hierarchy	5-stage needs pyramid: Physiological → Safety → Social → Esteem → Self-Actualization.
Herzberg Two-Factor	Hygiene factors (salary/policy prevent dissatisfaction) vs. Motivators (responsibility/recognition build satisfaction).
Theory X vs Theory Y	Lazy, coercive workforce view (Theory X) vs. Self-motivated, creative workforce view (Theory Y).

One-Line Definitions for Exam Revision

- **Conscientiousness:** Big Five trait reflecting organization, dependability, and goal discipline.
- **Machiavellianism:** Personality attribute characterized by emotional detachment and belief that ends justify means.
- **Job Enrichment:** Vertical expansion of job duties to increase employee autonomy and responsibility.
- **Hygiene Factors:** Extrinsic job factors whose presence prevents dissatisfaction but does not motivate.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions

1. Define Personality. What are its four main determinants?

Personality is the dynamic organization of psychophysical systems determining an individual's unique adjustment to environment. Determinants: Heredity, Environment, Culture, and Situation.

2. List the Big Five personality traits (OCEAN). Which trait best predicts job performance?

Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, and Neuroticism (Emotional Stability). Conscientiousness is the single best predictor of overall job performance.

3. Differentiate between Internal and External Locus of Control.

Internals believe their own efforts determine success/failure; Externals believe outcomes are dictated by outside forces like luck, fate, or powerful people.

4. Compare Type A and Type B personalities.

Type A individuals are impatient, competitive, aggressive, and time-driven; Type B individuals are relaxed, steady, patient, and less prone to stress.

5. Explain Maslow's Need Hierarchy Theory.

Maslow proposed human needs follow a 5-tier pyramid: Physiological, Safety, Social, Esteem, and

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions (contd.)

Self-Actualization. Individuals must fulfill lower-level needs before higher-level needs motivate them.

6. What are Hygiene Factors according to Herzberg? Give examples.

Hygiene factors are extrinsic job elements (salary, company policy, working conditions) that prevent job dissatisfaction when present, but do not create positive motivation.

7. Contrast McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y.

Theory X assumes workers are inherently lazy, dislike responsibility, and require coercion; Theory Y assumes workers are self-motivated, creative, and seek responsibility.

8. What is the difference between Job Enlargement and Job Enrichment?

Job Enlargement expands work horizontally by adding similar tasks; Job Enrichment expands work vertically by adding autonomy, planning, and control.

9. Define Machiavellianism in an organizational context.

It is a personality trait where an individual is pragmatic, maintains emotional distance, and manipulates situations believing the end justifies the means.

10. What factors influence employee motivation in Indian organizations?

Job security, family-oriented benefits, respect for hierarchy, paternalistic leadership, and performance-linked incentives.